

Greystar Real Estate Partners — Developer Pursuit Dossier

Prepared for: Jim DesRoches, KOR Structural — San Diego trip June 29–July 1, 2026 **Date:** June 26, 2026 **Author:** KOR BD Research

FRAMING: KOR is already Greystar’s structural engineer of record for concrete luxury high-rises in San Diego (525 Olive, completed 2022; 6th & Palm, under construction through 2028). This dossier is about relationship elevation + geographic expansion into Vancouver BC, not cold pursuit in San Diego.

1. Snapshot

Item	Detail
Company	Greystar Real Estate Partners, LLC
HQ	Charleston, SC (offices in Vancouver BC, Toronto, Los Angeles, San Diego, and 25+ US markets)
Founder / CEO	Bob Faith — Chairman & CEO (email: rafaith@greystar.com, confirmed public)
Scale	\$79B+ total AUM; \$36.5B regulatory AUM (Q1 2026); 1.1M+ units/beds managed globally
NMHC Ranking	#1 developer on 2026 developer list; perennial top-3 builder and manager
Model	Fully integrated: develop + self-GC (Greystar Construction) + manage; no third-party GC
Canada Entry	2022 — Vancouver BC office + Toronto office; 15 staff, 12 BC-based
KOR Relationship	Confirmed incumbent SE on SD concrete high-rises — invoiced via Greystar Development West, LLC (existing Deltek client entity)
Deltek Client Entity	Greystar Development West, LLC — existing billing/relationship infrastructure
SD Architect Partner	JWDA Architects (Joseph Wong Design Associates) — Greystar’s SD design-architect of record; KOR is JWDA’s structural for all SD Greystar high-rise work
Why Jim’s Trip Matters	Cement strategic relationship with Adam Covington + Jerry Brand; get warm intro to John Wilbeck (Vancouver) for the two active concrete rezoning projects

2. Business & Footprint

Who they are. Bob Faith founded Greystar in 1993 in Charleston, SC. Forty years later it is the largest apartment operator in the world — managing roughly 1.1 million units and beds across 17 countries — and a top-tier institutional real estate investment manager. Greystar’s \$79B total AUM spans Core, Core-Plus, Value-Add, and Opportunistic fund strategies.

What makes Greystar structurally different from every other developer KOR pursues. Greystar is fully vertically integrated: they are simultaneously the investment manager (capital), the developer (land + entitlements), the general contractor (via Greystar Construction), and the property manager. There is no third-party GC selection event. Structural engineer selection is made by Greystar’s internal development team during preconstruction — typically 12–18 months before groundbreaking. KOR earns work here by having relationships with Greystar’s development directors, not by chasing RFPs.

Product focus. Class A luxury concrete high-rise multifamily (15–25+ storeys), purpose-built student housing, and mixed-use residential. Large-scale concrete is their flagship product — identical to KOR’s sweet spot. They do also build lower-density wood-frame suburban and some senior living, but the prestige pipeline in KOR’s markets is all concrete.

Geographic expansion. Greystar entered Canada in 2022, starting in Victoria BC (University Heights). Their stated Canadian focus is BC, Alberta, and Ontario. Their two active Vancouver rezoning sites (both concrete, both DIALOG) represent the leading edge of a multi-decade

Canadian concrete high-rise pipeline. Per John Wilbeck's public statements, Canada is a strategic expansion priority at the highest level of the organization.

3. Active Pipeline in KOR's Markets

San Diego (KOR is existing incumbent SE for concrete high-rise)

Project	Location	Scale	Status	SE of Record	Notes
525 Olive	Bankers Hill	20 stories, 204 units, 417,500 SF	Completed Aug 2022	KOR Structural	JWDA arch; McParlane MEP; Greystar Construction GC; LEED certified; "Best Multifamily Project of the Year" — SDBJ
6th & Palm	Bankers Hill (1.3-acre block adj. Balboa Park)	20 stories, 214 units, 442,000 SF	Under construction (GB Sep 2025; completion early 2028)	KOR Structural	JWDA arch; Ascentris + Palm Properties equity JV; historic house preserved as co-working hub; ultra-luxury
Ancora	Little Italy (110 Beech St)	22 stories, 220 units (micro)	Pre-leasing / completing late 2025	Unconfirmed	479 SF studios; \$2,500–\$4,650/mo; 400-person waitlist at pre-leasing
Accolade Campanile	SDSU (Montezuma + Campanile Dr)	6 stories, 310 units / 605 beds	Under construction (GB Nov 2025; complete Jun 2028)	VCA Structural	JWDA arch; Kanden/Tokyo Tatemono JV; student housing; \$130M; leasing Aug 2027

Key pattern: JWDA Architects is Greystar's San Diego architect of record for high-rise. KOR is JWDA's structural partner. VCA Structural enters on lower-rise / student housing product. KOR's moat = the JWDA relationship on concrete high-rise.

British Columbia (Vancouver — open competition, SE unconfirmed)

Project	Location	Scale	Status	SE of Record	Notes
1527 Main St	Main/SkyTrain, Vancouver	22 + 18 storeys (concrete), 371 rental units; 7-storey shared podium	Rezoning approved Jul 8, 2025 ; dev permit submitted Sep 2025	Not publicly confirmed	DIALOG arch + planning consultant Pooni Group; \$80M land (former McDonald's); 70.1m height; no construction start announced
1770 W 12th Ave	Burrard + 12th, Vancouver (Westside)	21 storeys (concrete), 243 rental units; 6-storey podium	Rezoning approved May 20, 2025	Not publicly confirmed	DIALOG arch; \$41M land (2023); 20% below-market rental floor area; 66.7m height; dev permit stage
University Heights	Saanich, Victoria	5 buildings (1–8 storey, wood-frame), 593 rental units; 113K SF grocery retail	Delivering phased through 2026	Not confirmed	Minto JV (Minto 45%, inst. investor 45%, Greystar 10% as dev. manager); not KOR core product (wood-frame)

Critical note on DIALOG: DIALOG is a fully integrated multi-disciplinary firm offering architecture, structural, mechanical, and electrical engineering in-house. They have used external structural engineers on complex high-rise projects (e.g., Glotman Simpson on Vancouver House with BIG). It is unconfirmed whether DIALOG will handle structural in-house or engage an external SE for the 22+18 storey 1527 Main and 21-storey 1770 W 12th concrete towers. This is the key question Jim should ask Wilbeck.

Southern California (other Greystar markets, noted for completeness)

Project	Location	Scale	Status	Notes
Row at Red Hill	Santa Ana (Orange County)	1,100 units, 4 buildings, \$650M	Opened Aug 2024 (parts still finishing)	Greystar's largest-ever project; AO Architects; SE not publicly confirmed
Birchway Angle Lake	SeaTac, WA (PNW)	Apartments	Completing mid-2026	CT Engineers (structural); Weinstein A+U arch — KOR market reference only

4. Who Decides Structural / Who to Know

Greystar's integrated model means the development director in each region owns the design team selection. Greystar Construction is already the GC — no GC bid event. The structural pick happens at the development level, 12–18 months before groundbreaking.

Name	Title	Geography	Contact	Priority
Adam Covington	Senior Director, Development	San Diego	LinkedIn confirmed; @greystar.com pattern (not verified)	Priority 1 — SD relationship holder; quoted on 6th & Palm GB; joined Greystar Mar 2021 (former StreetLights Residential); UC San Diego Economics grad
Jerry Brand	Executive Director, Development & Construction	Western Region (CA, NW, AZ)	LinkedIn confirmed; @greystar.com pattern	Priority 2 — Western pipeline authority; joined Greystar 2011; former MD Pacific Urban Residential; 40+ year career; \$15B+ in transactions; controls SD + Portland + Phoenix pipeline above Adam
John Wilbeck	Managing Director, Development — Canada	Vancouver BC	LinkedIn confirmed; @greystar.com pattern	Priority 3 — only path into Vancouver BC concrete towers; joined Greystar 2021; former Hines MD (Western Canada); 12-person Vancouver team; two approved concrete rezonings now in dev permit
Kevin Kaberna	Co-Head & Executive Director, Americas Principal Business	North America (US, Canada, S. America)	LinkedIn confirmed	Senior to Jerry Brand; governs investment management + D&C for all Americas; useful for firm-level relationship if Bob Faith channel activates
Bob Faith	Founder, Chairman & CEO	Charleston SC	rafaith@greystar.com (confirmed public)	C-suite access only if Jim has a direct relationship; useful for a personal letter or high-level introduction

Approach — SD: Adam Covington is the day-to-day relationship. Jerry Brand is the relationship that matters for pipeline beyond today's active sites. Jim should meet both while in San Diego and ask Brand directly whether KOR is on the approved consultant list for the western region.

Approach — Vancouver: The only path is John Wilbeck directly. He is a Vancouver-based developer with a Hines background — a sophisticated operator who will understand KOR's SD track record. The ask is: are the 1527 Main and 1770 W 12th SE decisions made, and if DIALOG is handling structural in-house, what does that leave for an independent high-rise SE?

5. Competitive Reality

San Diego — KOR is the incumbent; protect and deepen

KOR has now performed structural engineering on two consecutive Greystar luxury concrete high-rises in San Diego's Bankers Hill:

- 525 Olive (2022) — won "Best Multifamily" from SDBJ
- 6th & Palm (2025–2028) — currently under construction, highest-profile SD rental tower

The gateway is the JWDA relationship. JWDA has been Greystar's architect of record for both projects. As long as KOR and JWDA's relationship is intact, KOR is effectively the go-to SE for Greystar SD concrete high-rise. **There is no confirmed incumbent SE for any future SD sites beyond 6th & Palm — the next opportunity is open.**

For student housing and lower-rise: VCA Structural is the confirmed SE on Accolade Campanile (6-story SDSU housing, also JWDA-designed). KOR is not being displaced from high-rise; VCA is being used for a different product type.

Pacific Northwest — CT Engineers

On Birchway Angle Lake (SeaTac), Greystar used CT Engineers (Seattle-based) as structural. This is outside KOR's markets and consistent with using local SE firms per region. Not a displacement threat in SD or Vancouver.

Vancouver — DIALOG structural is the primary barrier

DIALOG is an integrated firm. If they perform structural in-house on 1527 Main and 1770 W 12th, there is no SE slot for KOR. However:

1. Vancouver House (DIALOG architecture) used **Glotman Simpson** as external SE — proof that DIALOG does use external SEs on major concrete high-rise work.
2. 1527 Main at 22 + 18 storeys is complex high-rise work — there is a real question whether DIALOG's structural group will handle it solo.
3. KOR needs to ask — if DIALOG handles structural, KOR's path is a peer-review or special studies role; if DIALOG hires external, KOR is a strong candidate.

Glotman Simpson is the Vancouver concrete high-rise structural incumbent (Vancouver House, multiple others). They are KOR's primary displacement competitor if KOR pursues the Vancouver DIALOG channel.

6. KOR Angle & How to Win

Core narrative for Jim: KOR is Greystar's proven structural partner for the exact product type they are now bringing to Canada. The credentials are real and current — two concrete luxury towers in San Diego, one complete and award-winning, one actively rising. Jim's visit is about converting that project-level relationship into a regional-level strategic preferred vendor relationship, and using the SD track record as the opening argument for Vancouver.

Talking points:

1. **Proven track record within Greystar.** 525 Olive (award-winning, 2022) and 6th & Palm (active, 2028 completion) are the exact product type Greystar is now developing in Vancouver. KOR has already solved the structural problems Greystar's Canadian team will face on a 20+ storey concrete tower.
2. **Dual-market coverage is unique.** No structural firm has KOR's active, simultaneous presence in both San Diego and Vancouver BC on Greystar's own projects. This cross-border value proposition is genuinely rare in the SE market and directly relevant to a firm expanding from the US into Canada.
3. **Greystar Development West, LLC is an established client.** KOR already has Greystar Development West invoiced through Deltek — this is not a cold approach. Use this as evidence of a working relationship, not just aspirational pursuit.
4. **DIALOG relationship is worth probing.** DIALOG is the architect on both Vancouver rezonings. Even if they handle structural in-house, KOR's approach to John Wilbeck can surface whether an independent peer review, vibration study, or construction phase structural specialist is in scope — which would be a legitimate entry point.

Concrete asks for Jim on this trip:

1. **Meet Adam Covington in San Diego.** Confirm 6th & Palm progress, ask what comes next in the SD pipeline, and specifically request a warm email introduction to John Wilbeck in Vancouver. Covington vouching for KOR to Wilbeck is worth more than a cold LinkedIn outreach.
 2. **Request a meeting with Jerry Brand.** Brand controls the western region at the executive level. Jim's ask: "Is KOR on Greystar's approved structural consultant list for the West Coast, and if not, how do we get there?" This converts a project-level relationship into a regional framework relationship.
 3. **Contact John Wilbeck for a Vancouver intro call.** Email within 48 hours of returning from the SD trip (while the Covington introduction is warm). Reference the SD track record and the two approved Vancouver concrete sites. The single question: is the structural engineering role on 1527 Main and 1770 W 12th open to an external SE, or is DIALOG handling it in-house?
 4. **Explore the Greystar Development West billing relationship.** Confirm with Adam Covington (or the Greystar Development team) that KOR's contracts and invoices flow through Greystar Development West, LLC, and that this entity has visibility in Vancouver. This administrative clarity ensures there is no friction when KOR proposes structural services in Canada.
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7. Sources

- [Greystar + Ascentris: 6th & Palm Groundbreaking \(Sep 2025\)](#)
- [JWDA Inc — 6th & Palm Project Page \(confirms KOR Structural as SE\)](#)
- [JWDA Inc — 525 Olive Project Page \(confirms KOR Structural as SE\)](#)
- [JWDA Inc — Accolade Campanile Project Page \(confirms VCA Structural as SE\)](#)
- [San Diego Business Journal — Bankers Hill Luxury Apartment Tower \(6th & Palm\)](#)
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- [Shape Your City Vancouver — 1770 W 12th Ave Rezoning](#)
- [Daily Hive — 3,000 New Homes Including 15 Towers Approved by Vancouver \(Fall 2025\)](#)
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- [RENX — Greystar in Early Stages of Canadian Expansion](#)
- [RENX — Minto + Greystar JV Acquires BC Mall \(University Heights\)](#)
- [Multi-Housing News — Greystar Starts Work on San Diego Student Housing \(Accolade Campanile\)](#)
- [Multifamily Dive — Greystar's Largest-Ever Project Opens in SoCal \(Row at Red Hill\)](#)
- [Greystar — Adam Covington LinkedIn](#)
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- [AO Architects — The Row at Red Hill Project Page](#)
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- [DIALOG — Structural Engineering Services \(integrated firm confirmation\)](#)
- [DIALOG — Vancouver House \(Glotman Simpson as external SE precedent\)](#)
- [Multi-Housing News — Greystar's \\$100M 525 Olive Project Nears Completion](#)
- [YieldPro — Ancora Little Italy Pre-Leasing \(2025\)](#)
- [Greystar — Jerry Brand Bio](#)
- [Greystar — Kevin Kaberna Bio](#)
- [California Water Board — Greystar Development West LLC, Big Horn Apartments \(entity reference\)](#)